

Q So basically, a one-stop shop for all professionals out there?

A Well, yes, it's an absolutely perfect device for the professionals out there. And that segment is growing exponentially in India. Weddings is one of the largest industries for us that we cater to. And about a decade ago, in any locality you would find in one or two guys who were known for video. Today that segment is growing exponentially because Tier 2, and Tier 3 growth is pretty good. The other thing we have witnessed is the budding of many entrepreneurs. For example, I'm a professional, but on the weekend, I'd like to be a wedding photographer. So, we've seen that segment growing very fast for us. I just took an example of the wedding industry here, but there is also wildlife which for a long time has been a very niche segment, but we are starting to see growth in the segment as well. I don't need to talk much about OTT and the type of content that's coming up. But there has been exponential growth. At Canon, we have really strengthened our mirrorless full-frame system which we call the EOS R system launched in 2018 with our first EOS R. We followed it up then with the EOS RP then the EOS R5, EOS R6 and EOS R3, which is the high-end model in the mirrorless category. Then we launched the EOS R7 and EOS R10, special models for vloggers. So, we have set a solid range for our consumers because we are really catering to enthusiasts as well as professionals, content creators and movie makers. We also have a range of full-fledged cinema models as well with us with our robust Cinema EOS line-up.

Q We'd still like to press you on the headlining features that you guys think are the aces of the EOS R6 Mark II, for example, the 6K video recording, (with an external recorder), 40 shots per second on the electronic shutter. So some things like that. What are you guys the most proud of having on this camera?

A So, the first feature that we are proud of having on the EOS R6 Mark II is the 6K oversampling and getting 4K at 60p. That's one from the movie creator's perspective. It has C-log 3 recording

and of course, as you mentioned, 6K RAW recording in an external device. For photographs, of course, the 40 fps or the RAW burst at 30 fps are both key features of this particular camera. The HDR mode especially in photos for moving subjects that's one of the big features as well.

Q You guys have really updated the autofocus for the R6 Mk II. Now it is much more sticky than the previous iterations.

A So yes, the autofocus is basically the function of our sensor and the algorithms used in it. The EOS R as such is known for its amazing ultra-fast autofocus.

Q How does the Indian consumer receive these high-end, full-frame mirrorless cameras? Is it sort of being adopted only by professionals? Or is it also being picked up by amateurs and enthusiasts as well? What does your data say?

A So, the answer is yes. We are witnessing very promising growth in the amateur segment. While there have always been a lot of enthusiasts in the photography segment, we've started to see that they've started to upgrade themselves to high-end devices. It could be even an EOS R5 or EOS R3. A lot more increase in the segment and if I had to pick their main application, I would say it's wildlife. A lot of amateurs are now adopting wildlife photography. We've seen that big growth coming in especially post-COVID. Even pre-COVID, we saw that the wildlife segment was growing but it's even more now. And otherwise, in the other genres, there's definite growth as well. Wedding is our biggest segment, with close to about 10 million weddings happening in India. We are still a very young country, so it's really the driver of our growth here. People in Tier 2, Tier 3 cities invest anywhere between, let's say, 300000 to 1000000 from different classes of photographers. But yes, clearly there is investment in this segment. And that's why Canon's been launching a range of EOS R systems. On the APSC front, which is the mid-segment, we recently launched the EOS R7 and the EOS R10. The EOS R10

especially caters to the vloggers. When I started our conversation, I mentioned vloggers being a huge contributor to our growth engine. So, we've seen that the EOS R10 adaptability or EOS M50 are models that are almost a benchmark for vloggers. So, I can conclude by saying that almost every segment, we've seen stronger growth.

Q What are Canon's plans in the AR and VR segment? Will we be seeing any products like the RF dual fisheye 3D AR lens? If yes, what shape would that kind of technology take?

A Honestly, we wouldn't be able to comment on that front at this moment because we never comment on any future products. But as you rightly mentioned, the VR fisheye lens that we've launched, is really the first foothold into this field and we've started to see some really good applications that are coming in like real estate and movie maker segments. But what we do is that we are consistently studying patterns. There's a consistent study that we do and the feedback keeps going back to our Tokyo headquarters. So please expect the best to come in.

Q Do you guys feel the global chip shortage impact on the market is sort of reduced? So what is your thought on how this will impact the pricing and availability of cameras going into next year?

A So, the shortage of semiconductors is obviously a global issue. And chip makers across the board are facing the challenge to meet the demand and supply gap. And we've seen that for a long time. But it seems that there is an ease out that we have from a different industry, but we've seen just not the chip issue. We've also seen a lot of part supply issues. Commenting on parts coming from across the globe, has definitely impacted firstly the production and the other is that the cost has been going up. While chip shortage may be easing out, there remain other parts supply issues. Even logistics costs have gone up all the way to the roof and we are trying our best to manage the situation. In the first quarter, we do see some sort of impact of these elements but the situation is still unpredictable. ■